CRM Solution Supplier Briefing

UWC

Introducing UWC

1. Introduction

United World Colleges (UWC) is a global education movement with a mission to make education a force to unite people, nations and cultures for peace and a sustainable future. The organisation aims to inspire young people to use their talents and energy to create positive change in the world, regardless of the paths they choose in life.

Founded in 1962, UWC has grown into an international network of schools, educational programmes, national committees and alumni communities. Students from diverse cultural, socio-economic and geographic backgrounds live and learn together while studying the International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme (IBDP), an internationally recognised pre-university curriculum that prepares students academically and socially for life beyond school.

The purpose of this document is to provide potential suppliers with an overview of how the UWC movement operates and how digital systems support its core activities. These include student applications and selection, scholarship management, events and community activity, and the governance of the global network.

UWC International is undertaking a programme to modernise its digital platforms in order to support the movement more effectively, improve collaboration across the network, and provide a unified view of engagement with the organisation.

2. The UWC Movement

UWC is best understood as a global movement rather than a single organisation. The movement is composed of a number of interconnected entities working together to deliver a shared mission.

Today the UWC movement includes:

- **18 UWC schools and colleges located on four continents**
- **National Committees in more than 150 countries and territories** responsible for identifying and selecting students
- **An international office with teams based in London and Berlin** that provides coordination and strategic direction for the movement
- **A global alumni community of more than 85,000 individuals** who studied at UWC schools or participated in UWC programmes

The movement is intentionally diverse. Students selected through UWC come from a wide range of cultural, economic and social backgrounds and are chosen primarily on the basis of their potential to contribute positively to society.

3. Role of UWC International

UWC International acts as the global body that connects and supports the different elements of the movement. Its role is to ensure that the network works collectively toward the shared mission and strategy.

The responsibilities of UWC International include setting the strategic direction of the movement, supporting collaboration between schools and national committees, overseeing global fundraising initiatives, developing the organisation's international profile, and coordinating communications across the network.

UWC International also provides operational support functions including finance, governance, education development, fundraising, communications, and human resources. These functions support both the work of the International Office itself and the broader network of schools and committees.

For the purposes of the CRM programme, UWC International is the primary organisation commissioning and governing the implementation of new digital systems.

4. The Educational Model

The UWC educational model combines rigorous academic study with experiential learning and community engagement.

Students typically attend a UWC school for the final two years of secondary education while studying the International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme. Alongside academic learning, students participate in community service, leadership development, and collaborative activities designed to foster empathy, responsibility and intercultural understanding.

The diversity of the student body is considered fundamental to the educational experience. Students from many different countries and backgrounds live and study together in a residential environment, encouraging dialogue, collaboration and mutual understanding.

This educational model relies on the ability to identify talented and motivated students worldwide and to provide financial support where needed so that students are not excluded for economic reasons.

In addition to the International Baccalaureate, UWC coordinates a programme of short courses available to both young people and adults.

5. National Committees and Student Selection

Most students are selected through a global network of National Committees. These committees operate in more than 150 countries and territories and are largely run by volunteers who support the mission of UWC.

National Committees are responsible for promoting UWC locally and identifying young people who would benefit from the programme. Because committee members understand the local education systems and social context of their countries, they are able to assess applicants within that context and identify students with strong potential.

Committees also provide guidance and support to students and their families before and during their time at UWC.

The selection process generally involves multiple stages including application submission, evaluation of written materials, interviews, and final nomination of students to UWC schools.

6. Scholarships and Financial Support

Financial support is central to the UWC mission. The organisation aims to ensure that students are able to attend regardless of their financial circumstances.

As a result, the majority of students selected through National Committees receive financial assistance in order to attend UWC schools.

Scholarships are funded through a variety of sources including individual donors, philanthropic foundations, corporate partners and government programmes. These funding streams support both individual scholarships and larger initiatives designed to increase access to UWC education.

Managing these scholarships involves coordinating relationships between donors, students, schools and National Committees. It also involves reporting on the use of funds and the outcomes achieved by supported students.

7. The Student and Alumni Lifecycle

The relationship between an individual and UWC typically spans many years. An individual may first engage with UWC as an applicant. If selected, they become a student at a UWC school and participate in the educational programme. If their school place is funded through a scholarship, then they will also be a UWC Scholar. After completing their studies, they join the global alumni community.

Alumni remain connected to UWC through professional networks, volunteering opportunities, mentoring programmes and, in some cases, financial contributions that support future students.

Over time, many individuals engage with UWC in multiple roles. For example, a former student may later become a volunteer in a National Committee, an ambassador for the organisation, or a donor supporting scholarships for future generations.

Maintaining these long-term relationships is an important objective of the CRM programme.

8. Alumni, Donor and Community Engagement

The UWC alumni community forms an important part of the movement's global network. With more than 85,000 alumni around the world, this community provides an ongoing connection between the organisation and the individuals who have experienced its educational programmes.

Alumni engage with UWC in many ways, including mentoring students, supporting recruitment and outreach activities, volunteering within National Committees, participating in events, and contributing financially to scholarship programmes.

UWC also maintains relationships with donors, philanthropic partners and institutional supporters. These relationships often involve long-term engagement, reporting on the impact of funded programmes, and opportunities for donors to interact with students and alumni.

The CRM platform is expected to support the management of these relationships and the tracking of engagement over time.

9. Events and Convenings

Events play an important role in the life of the UWC movement. They bring together students, alumni, donors, volunteers and staff from across the network.

Events are organised at several levels within the movement. Some are global gatherings coordinated by UWC International, while others are organised by schools, National Committees or alumni groups.

Examples include community gatherings, alumni reunions, governance meetings, fundraising events, programme showcases and educational conferences. These events help maintain connections within the UWC community, strengthen partnerships and support the sharing of ideas across the network.

Because the network is globally distributed, events may take place in many different countries and involve participants from multiple parts of the movement.

10. Governance and Coordination

The governance of the UWC movement reflects its distributed structure.

UWC International provides strategic direction and coordination, working with the UWC International Board and Council to set priorities and oversee the development of the movement.

Schools and colleges operate as independent educational institutions, while National Committees function as locally organised volunteer bodies that support the mission within their countries.

This structure enables the movement to operate globally while maintaining strong local engagement. However, it also means that information about students, alumni, donors and volunteers is often held by different parts of the network.

One objective of the CRM transformation programme is to improve the ability to share and manage information across the movement while respecting the autonomy of its members.

11. Current Digital Landscape

The UWC network currently uses a range of digital tools to support its activities, including systems for managing applications, fundraising, communications and financial operations.

These systems have often developed independently over time and may be operated by different parts of the network.

As a result, the technology landscape is fragmented and relies on integrations and manual processes to share information across systems.

The CRM programme aims to improve this landscape by enabling better integration between systems and by providing a clearer view of engagement across the movement.

11. Current Digital Landscape

The UWC network currently uses a wide range of digital tools to support its activities, including systems for managing student applications, fundraising, communications, events and financial operations.

These systems have developed organically over time as different parts of the movement adopted technologies that met their immediate needs. As a result, the current technology ecosystem includes some overlapping platforms that perform similar or identical functions, and a significant amount of operational data is maintained in spreadsheets.

These spreadsheets are often used to track scholarships, programme funding allocations, event participation, donor engagement and operational reporting. While they provide flexibility for local teams, they also make it difficult to maintain consistent data and a unified view of activity across the network.

Integration between systems is currently limited. In many cases, data is transferred manually between platforms or shared through spreadsheets and ad-hoc processes. This lack of integration means that information about applicants, students, alumni, donors and partners may exist in multiple systems without a reliable mechanism for synchronisation or consolidation.

The core infrastructure used by UWC International is based on **Google Workspace**, which provides collaboration tools including email, document management and shared spreadsheets. These tools are widely used across the organisation and are an important part of day-to-day operations.

Fundraising and philanthropy development conducted by the International Office is managed through Raiser's Edge. The IO uses Business Central for financial accounting. Both these areas are out of scope of this project, save for any required integrations.

Another important consideration is the global nature of the UWC network. National Committees operate in many countries and jurisdictions, some of which have regulatory or technical restrictions on the use of certain digital platforms or cloud services. These constraints can influence which technologies can be adopted in different parts of the network and must therefore be considered when designing future system architecture.

The CRM transformation programme aims to address these challenges by creating a more coherent technology ecosystem. **The objective is to reduce duplication of systems, improve data integration across platforms, and provide a clearer and more consistent view of engagement across the UWC movement while supporting the needs of a globally distributed organisation.**

12. Users and Stakeholders

The future CRM solution will need to support a diverse set of users across the UWC movement.

These include staff at the UWC International Office, volunteers and administrators within National Committees, staff at UWC schools and colleges, and teams responsible for communications, fundraising and programme management.

Suppliers should assume the platform will support approximately:

- **International Office users:** [TBC]
- **National Committee administrators:** [TBC]
- **School and college users:** [TBC]
- **Fundraising and communications users:** [TBC]

In addition to internal users, the platform may interact with external stakeholders including applicants, alumni, donors and volunteers.

13. Objectives of the CRM Transformation

The primary goal of the CRM transformation programme is to enable UWC International and the wider movement to manage relationships more effectively across the full lifecycle of engagement with the organisation.

This includes supporting the journey from applicant to student, from student to alumnus, and from alumnus to volunteer or donor.

The programme aims to improve collaboration across the global network, provide better visibility of engagement and impact, and enable more effective fundraising and community building.

Ultimately, the goal is to support the mission of UWC by ensuring that the organisation has the tools and information it needs to sustain and expand its work.

CRM Solution Capability Overview

1. Introduction

The following section provides an overview of the functional capabilities that UWC International expects to be supported by the future CRM and digital platform ecosystem.

As described earlier, UWC operates through a distributed international network consisting of UWC schools and colleges, National Committees responsible for student selection, alumni communities, philanthropic partners and donors. The future digital ecosystem must therefore support collaboration across a global network while maintaining a coherent view of people, programmes and relationships.

The platform capabilities required to support this ecosystem can be grouped into several functional domains:

- Applications and Selection
- Scholar and Scholarship Management
- Fundraising and Partnerships
- Community Engagement
- Core CRM Functions
- Integrations
- Project Delivery

Together, these domains form the foundation of the CRM Solution.

The capabilities described in the following sections are intended to provide a structured view of the functions that the future platform will need to support. They should not be interpreted as a prescriptive system architecture, but rather as a way of grouping the underlying requirements described in the accompanying requirements catalogue.

Suppliers should therefore consider how their proposed solutions address these capability areas and how they would enable UWC International and the wider network to manage relationships, programmes and community engagement effectively over time.

Requirements related to fundraising will continue to be delivered by Raiser's Edge, and have therefore not been included in this overview. Financial accounting, through Business Central, is out of scope for the project. UWC is open to remaining requirements being delivered by a single technology or a set of technologies integrated together

2. Applications and Selection

One of the most important operational capabilities within UWC is the identification and selection of students from around the world. Each year, tens of thousands of applicants apply through a global network of National Committees, which are responsible for identifying young people who demonstrate the potential to contribute to the UWC mission.

The digital platform must support the full lifecycle of student applications and selection processes. This begins with the **applicant portal**, through which prospective students submit their applications and supporting materials. The portal must provide a user-friendly interface allowing applicants to complete structured application forms, upload documentation and provide additional information required by the selection process.

Application forms may vary depending on the programme, National Committee or educational pathway involved. As a result, the system must allow administrators to configure programmes and application structures through **programme configuration tools**. These capabilities will enable administrators to define application questions, eligibility requirements and selection workflows.

Applications often require supporting materials such as **recommendations** from teachers or other referees. The platform must therefore provide mechanisms for collecting and managing recommendation submissions while maintaining secure and confidential access to these materials.

The evaluation of applicants is typically conducted through structured review and interview processes. The system must support **assessment management**, enabling reviewers to evaluate candidates against defined criteria, record assessment outcomes and contribute to collaborative decision-making processes.

Selection processes generally occur in stages. The platform must therefore support the management of **selection stages**, allowing applicants to progress through review phases such as initial screening, interviews, selection activities, and final nomination.

Following selection, applicants may be nominated to specific UWC schools. The system must support **school place allocation**, ensuring that placement decisions consider factors such as the criterion of the schools and funding requirements.

Applicants may also provide additional information relating to financial circumstances or medical requirements. The platform must therefore support the secure collection of **financial and medical information**, together with mechanisms for **consent management** to ensure appropriate handling of personal data, and consent from parents/guardians for the application to be submitted.

Administrative users require tools to oversee and manage the overall selection process. The platform must therefore provide **administrative tools** for monitoring application pipelines, managing reviewer assignments and maintaining oversight of selection outcomes.

The platform should also be capable of supporting additional programmes beyond the core two-year school placements. For example, UWC offers shorter educational programmes and courses that may involve similar application workflows. The system should therefore support the management of **short courses and alternative programmes** where required.

3. Scholar and Scholarship Management

Once students are selected and placed within UWC schools, if they are in receipt of a scholarship, the platform must support the management of the scholar lifecycle and the funding that enables their participation.

The **scholar lifecycle capability** should provide visibility of the student journey from nomination and placement through to programme completion. This includes tracking the student's academic progress, their reports to donors, and the outcomes associated with their time within the movement.

Financial support is central to the UWC model. Many students attend UWC schools through scholarships funded by donors, foundations or partner organisations. The platform must therefore support comprehensive **scholarship management** capabilities that allow administrators to link scholarship funding with specific students, programmes and institutions.

Scholarships often include financial structures and conditions that must be tracked over time. The system must therefore support **financial tracking** of scholarship allocations, enabling UWC International to understand how funding is distributed and how resources are being used to support students across the network.

These capabilities will help ensure that UWC can manage scholarship funding transparently and effectively, while also supporting reporting obligations to donors and partners.

5. Community Engagement

UWC maintains a vibrant global community that includes alumni, volunteers, supporters and partners. Maintaining strong engagement with this community is an important aspect of sustaining the movement and supporting future generations of students.

The digital platform should support a **community portal** that allows members of the UWC community to connect with the organisation and with each other. This portal may provide access to opportunities for volunteering, mentoring, events and networking.

Engagement with the community often occurs through targeted communications and outreach activities. The system should therefore support **targeted engagement capabilities**, enabling staff to identify groups of individuals with shared characteristics or interests and communicate with them appropriately.

Community members frequently participate in events organised by alumni groups, National Committees or UWC schools. The system should therefore support **community event management**, enabling organisers to promote events, manage registrations and track attendance.

The UWC movement is characterised by strong networks of alumni and supporters. The platform should therefore support **community networks**, allowing individuals to connect through shared affiliations such as schools, geographic regions or areas of professional interest.

6. Core CRM Functions

Underlying all of the functional capabilities described above is a set of core CRM capabilities that enable the platform to operate effectively as a central relationship management system.

The system must support the management of **people and organisations**, providing structured records of individuals and institutional entities interacting with UWC. These records must support the representation of complex relationships, including affiliations with schools, National Committees, programmes and donor initiatives.

Because individuals may interact with UWC in multiple roles over time, the platform must support **relationship management capabilities** that allow these roles and interactions to be tracked across the organisation.

The system must also provide robust **roles and permissions management** so that users across the global network can access information appropriate to their responsibilities.

Automation is an important capability within modern CRM platforms. The system should therefore support **workflow automation**, enabling processes such as approvals, notifications and task assignments to be managed efficiently.

Given the international nature of the UWC network, the system must support **consent and data preference management** to ensure compliance with privacy regulations and to respect the communication preferences of individuals.

Maintaining high-quality data is critical for effective CRM operation. The platform should therefore include **data quality management capabilities** that support deduplication, validation and ongoing data governance.

Additional governance capabilities include **safeguarding and complaints management**, ensuring that the organisation can record and manage sensitive issues appropriately.

The system must also support **reporting and analysis**, enabling staff and leadership to understand trends across applications, fundraising, community engagement and programme outcomes.

The platform must provide strong **audit trail and compliance capabilities**, allowing UWC to track changes to records and ensure transparency in operational processes.

Given the important role played by National Committees in the UWC movement, the platform must also support **National Committee management**, allowing relationships between committees, volunteers and programmes to be represented effectively.

Finally, the CRM must support the broader **governance management** needs of the UWC which recognises the complexity of managing a global movement. This includes the ability to represent governance structures such as boards, committees and advisory groups; to manage the membership of these bodies; and to maintain records of appointments, terms of service and organisational roles. These capabilities will help UWC International maintain visibility of governance structures across the network and support the coordination of leadership and oversight activities.

7. Integrations

The CRM platform will form part of a broader digital ecosystem that includes other systems supporting functions such as financial management and marketing communications.

The platform must therefore provide strong **API accessibility**, enabling other systems to interact with CRM data securely and efficiently.

To support ongoing integration needs, the system should allow administrators to configure **interfaces and integration points** that connect with third-party systems. These integrations may include connections with marketing platforms, financial systems, online giving tools and other specialised applications used within the UWC ecosystem.

The system should also support **task automation**, enabling routine operational processes to be executed automatically and reducing the administrative burden on staff and volunteers.

8. Project Delivery

Successful implementation of the CRM platform will require a structured project delivery approach.

The implementation will involve the **configuration of platform capabilities** to align with UWC's operational requirements. This will include adapting workflows, data structures and interfaces to support the needs of the global network.

Existing data from legacy systems will need to be transferred into the new platform through **data migration processes**, ensuring that historical information is preserved and accessible.

Before deployment, the system will undergo **testing activities** to ensure that the platform functions correctly and supports the required operational processes.

Because the platform will be used across a diverse international network, **business change management** will be essential to support user adoption. This may include training, documentation and support materials for staff and volunteers.

Following deployment, the platform must support **ongoing support and continuous improvement**, enabling UWC to refine processes and capabilities as the organisation evolves.

CRM Solution Components

Applications & Selection

- Applicant Portal
- Programme Configuration
- Recommendations
- Assessment Management
- Selection Stages
- Application Forms
- School Place Allocation
- Nominations & Clearing
- Financial & Medical Information
- Consent Management
- Admin Tools
- Short Courses

Scholar & Scholarship

- Scholar Lifecycle
- Scholarship Management
- Financial Tracking

Fundraising & Partnerships

- Funded Programmes
- Individual Giving
- Institutional & Major Donors
- Donor Management
- Event Management
- UK Gift Aid Management

Community Engagement

- Community Portal
- Targeted Engagement
- Community Events
- Community Networks

Integrations

- API Accessibility
- Interface Configuration
- Third Party Integrations
- Task Automation

Project Delivery

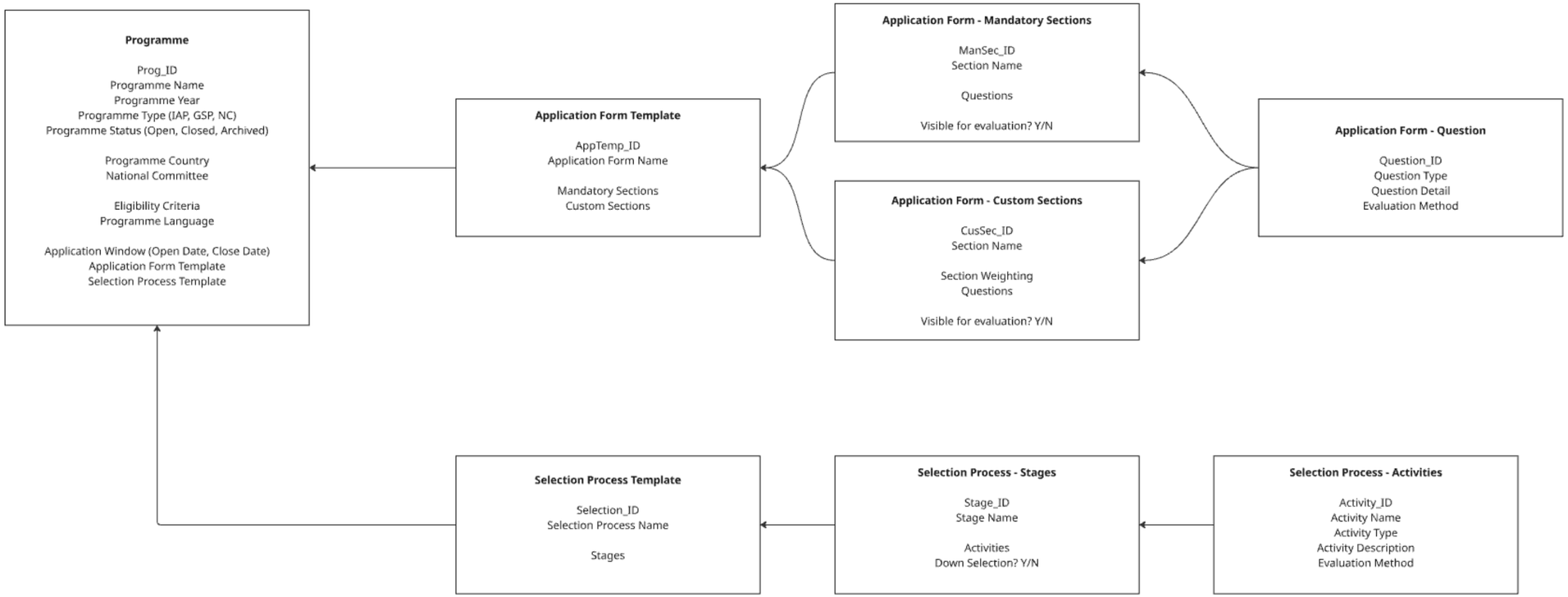
- Configuration
- Data Migration
- Testing
- Business Change
- Support & Continuous Improvement

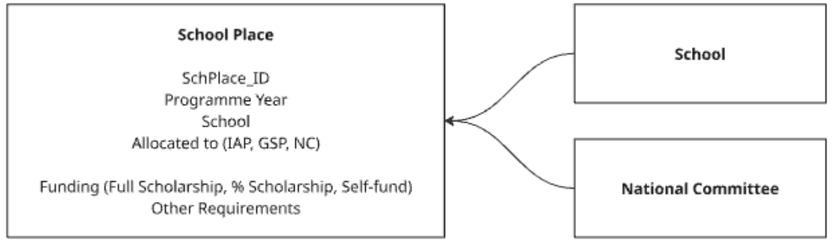
Core CRM Functions

- Roles & Permissions
- People and Organisations
- Relationship Management
- Workflow Automation
- Consent & Data Preferences
- Data Quality Management
- Safeguarding & Complaints
- Reporting & Analysis
- Audit Trail & Compliance
- Governance Management
- National Committee Management

Applications & Selection

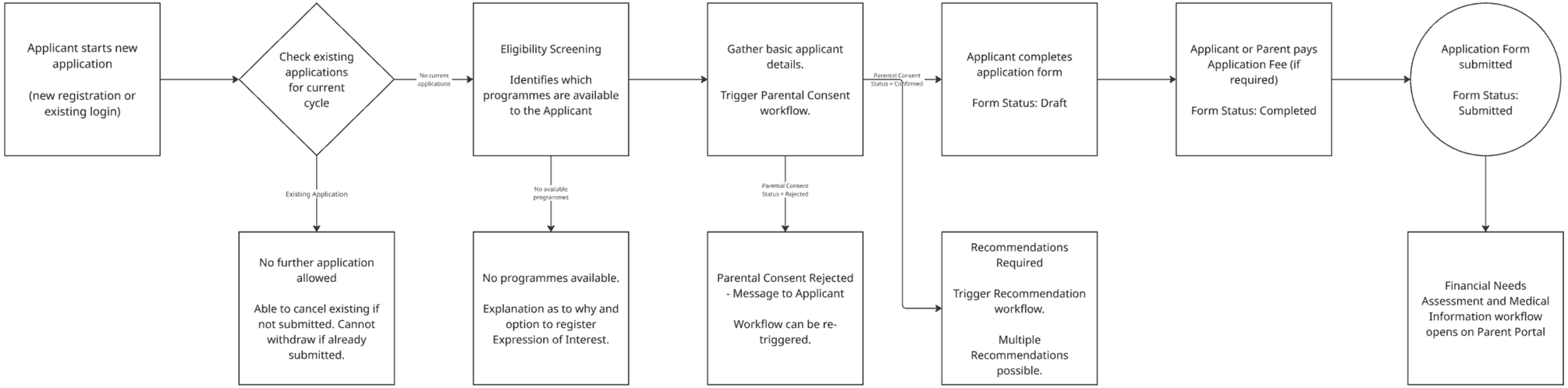
Application & Selection – Core Entities



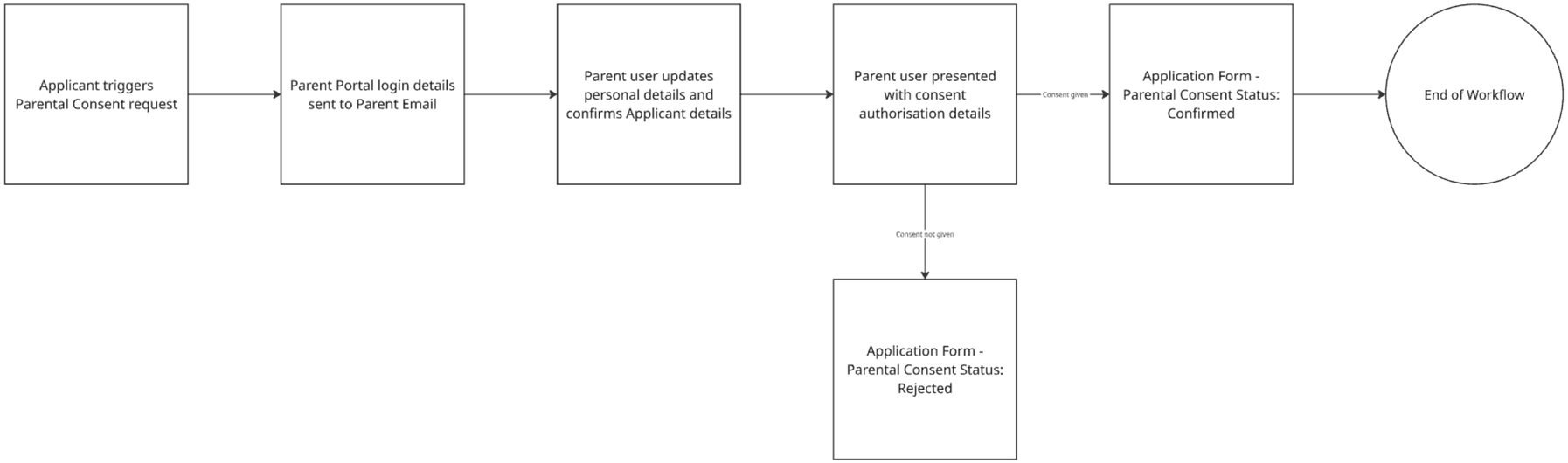


Application (1)

Application - Core Workflow

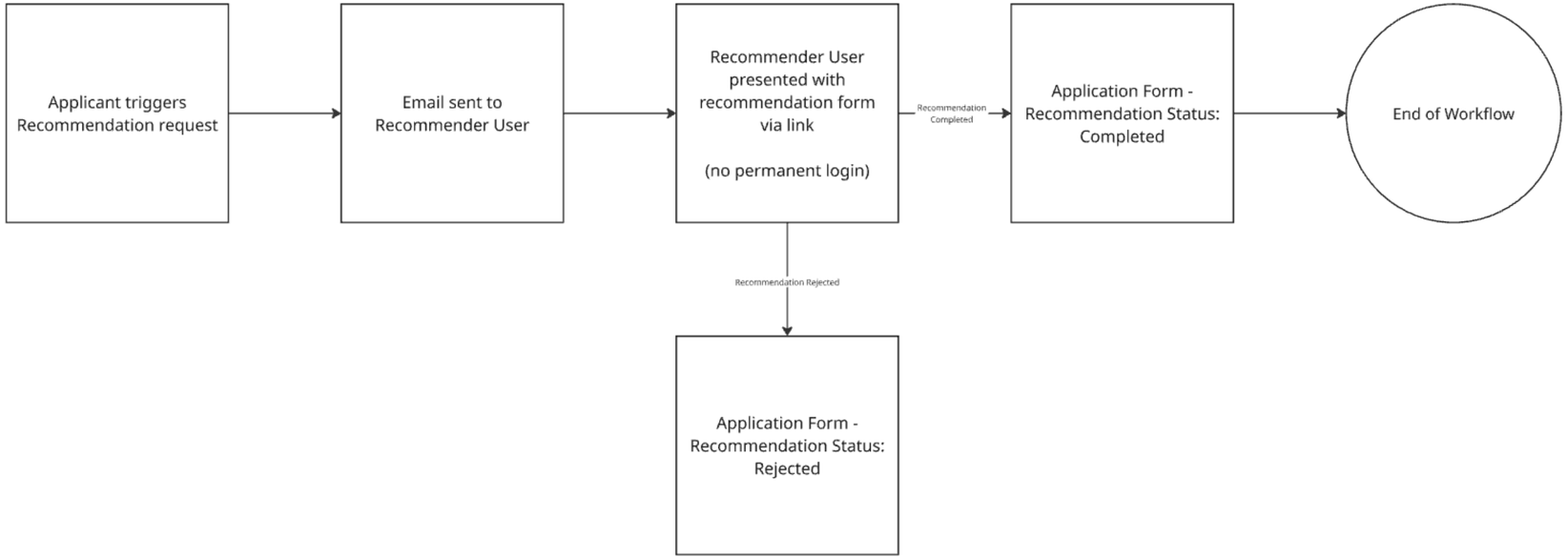


Application - Parental Consent Workflow

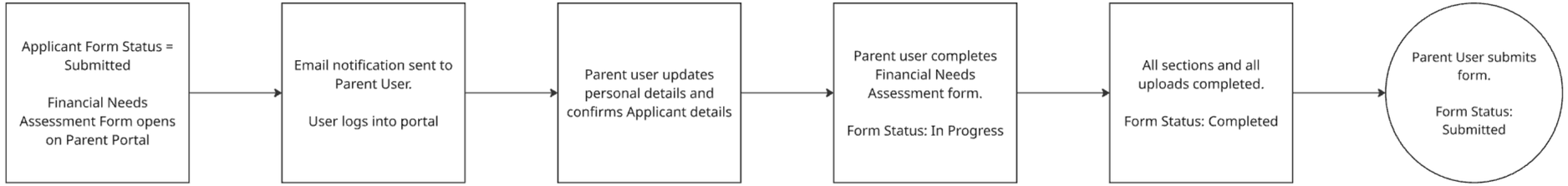


Application (2)

Application - Recommendation Workflow

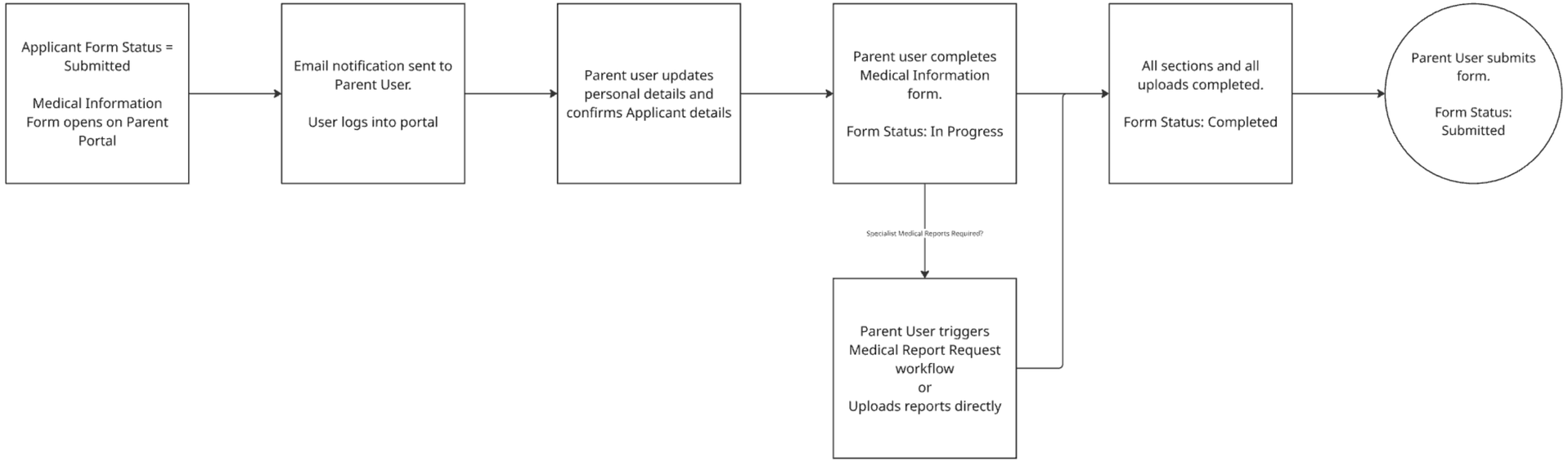


Application - Financial Needs Assessment Workflow



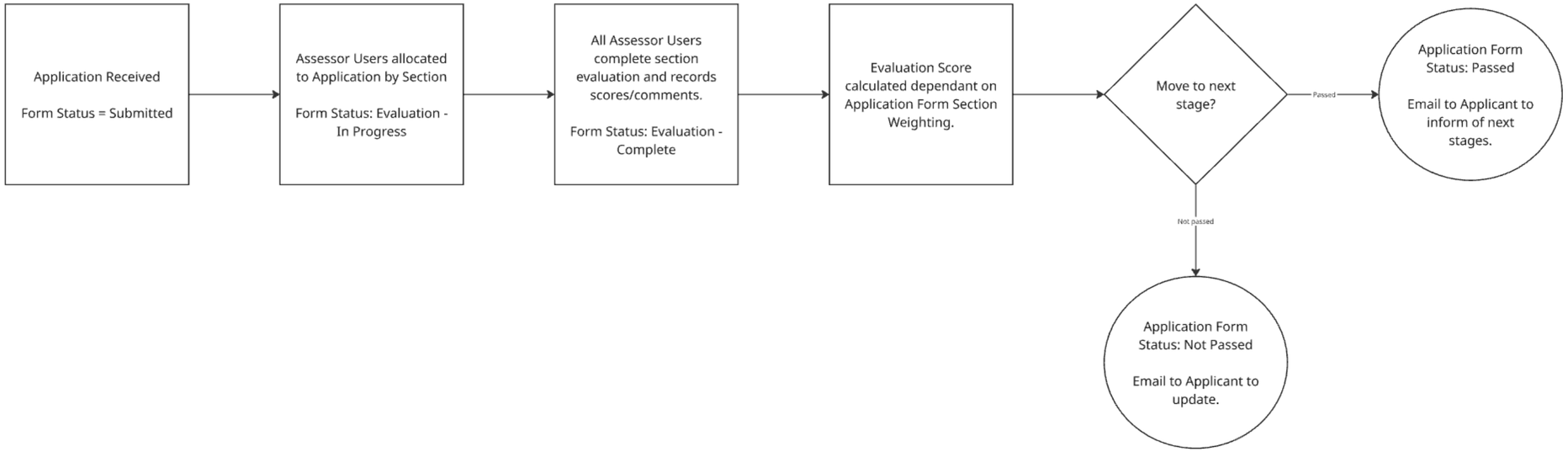
Application (3)

Application - Medical Information Workflow

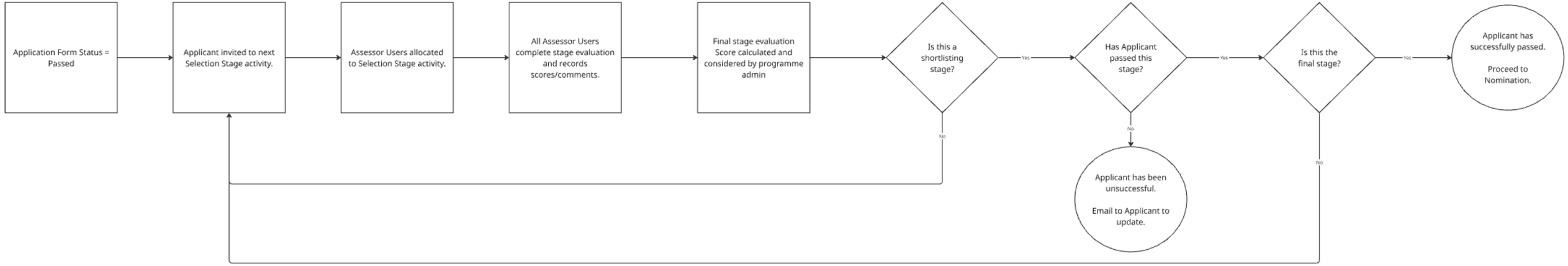


Selection (1)

Application Evaluation - Application Form Workflow

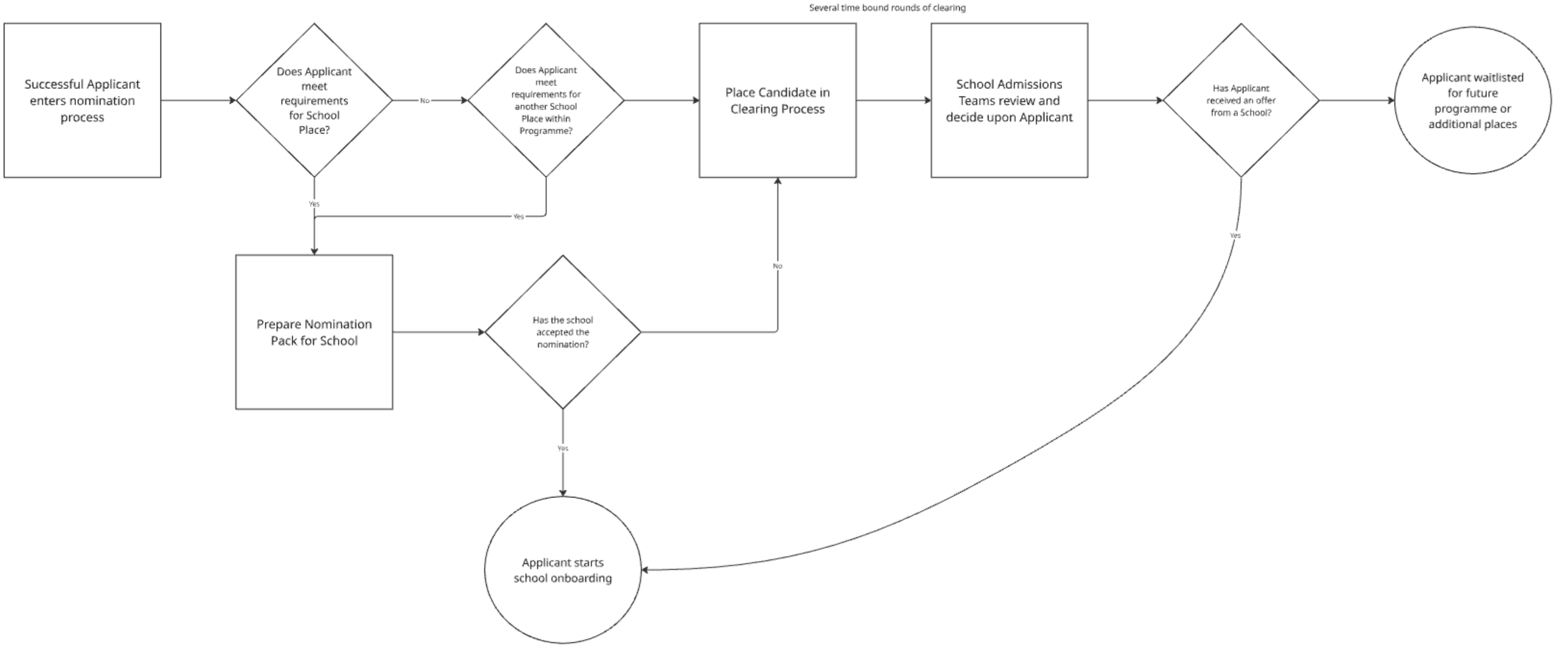


Application Evaluation - Selection Stage Workflow



Selection (2)

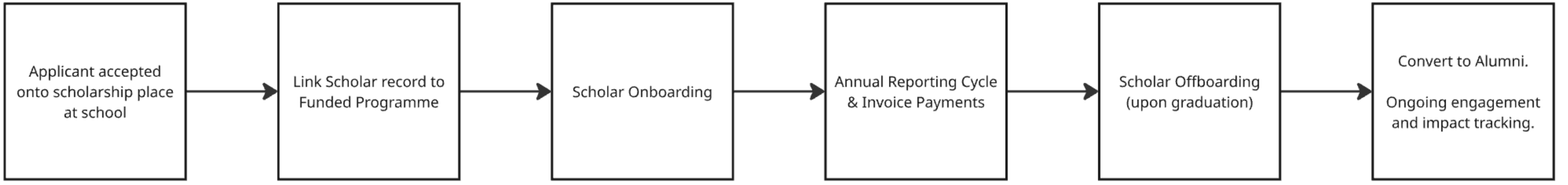
Nomination Workflow



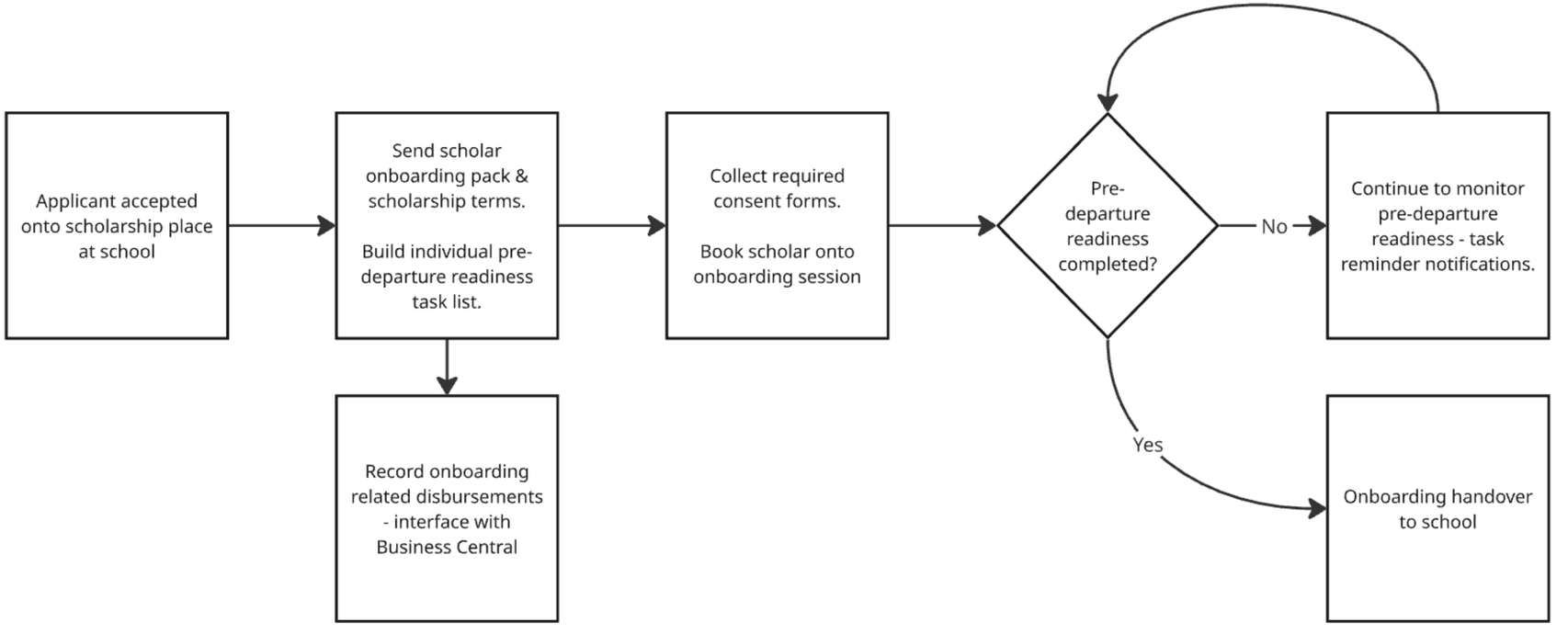
Scholar & Scholarship

Scholar Lifecycle (1)

Highlevel Scholar Lifecycle

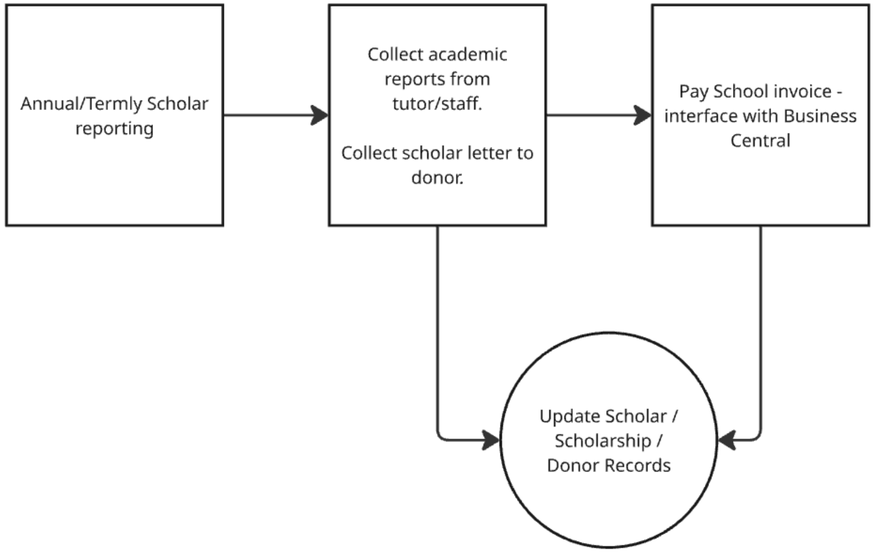


Scholar Onboarding



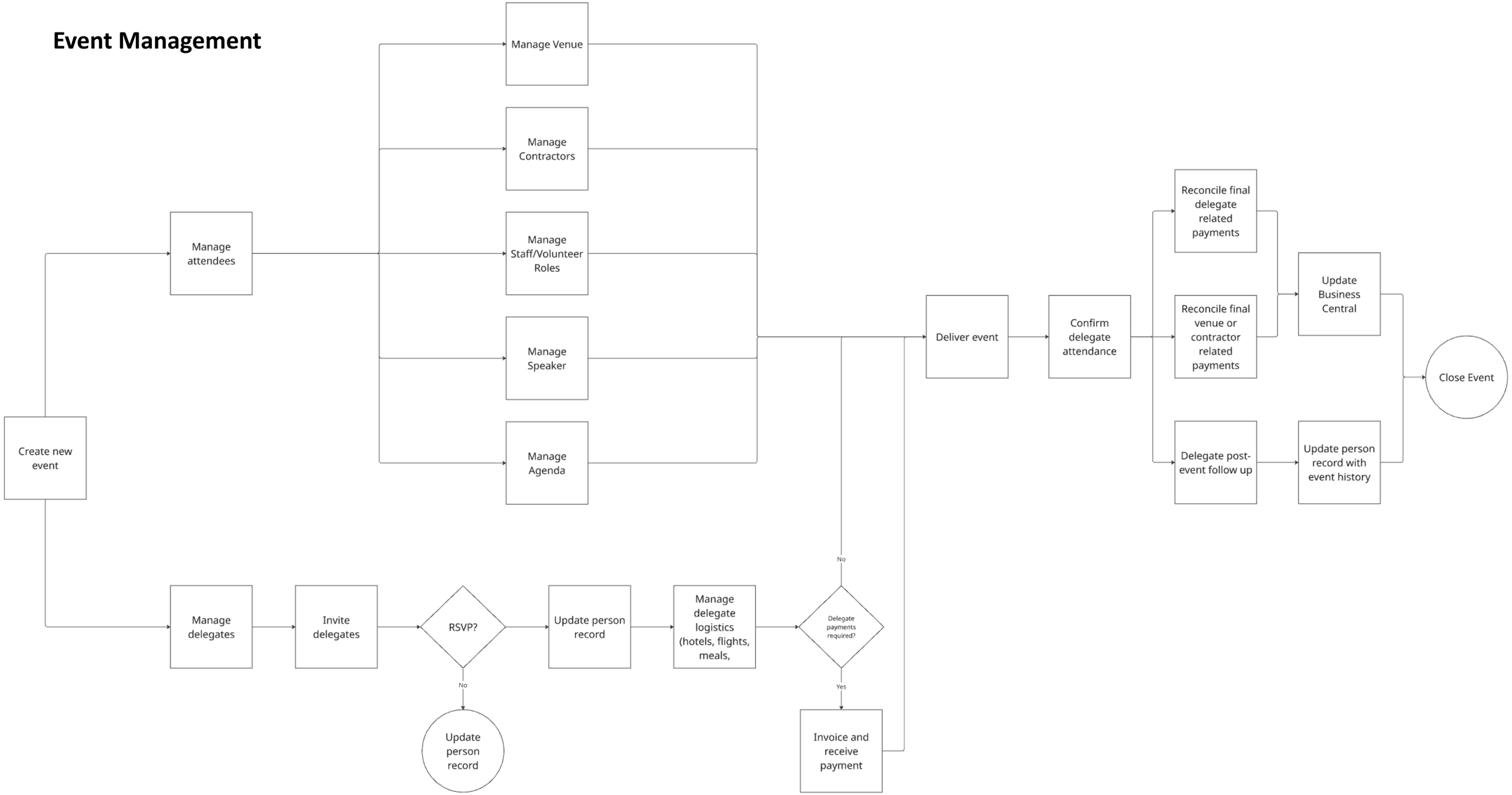
Scholar Lifecycle (2)

Annual Scholar Reporting



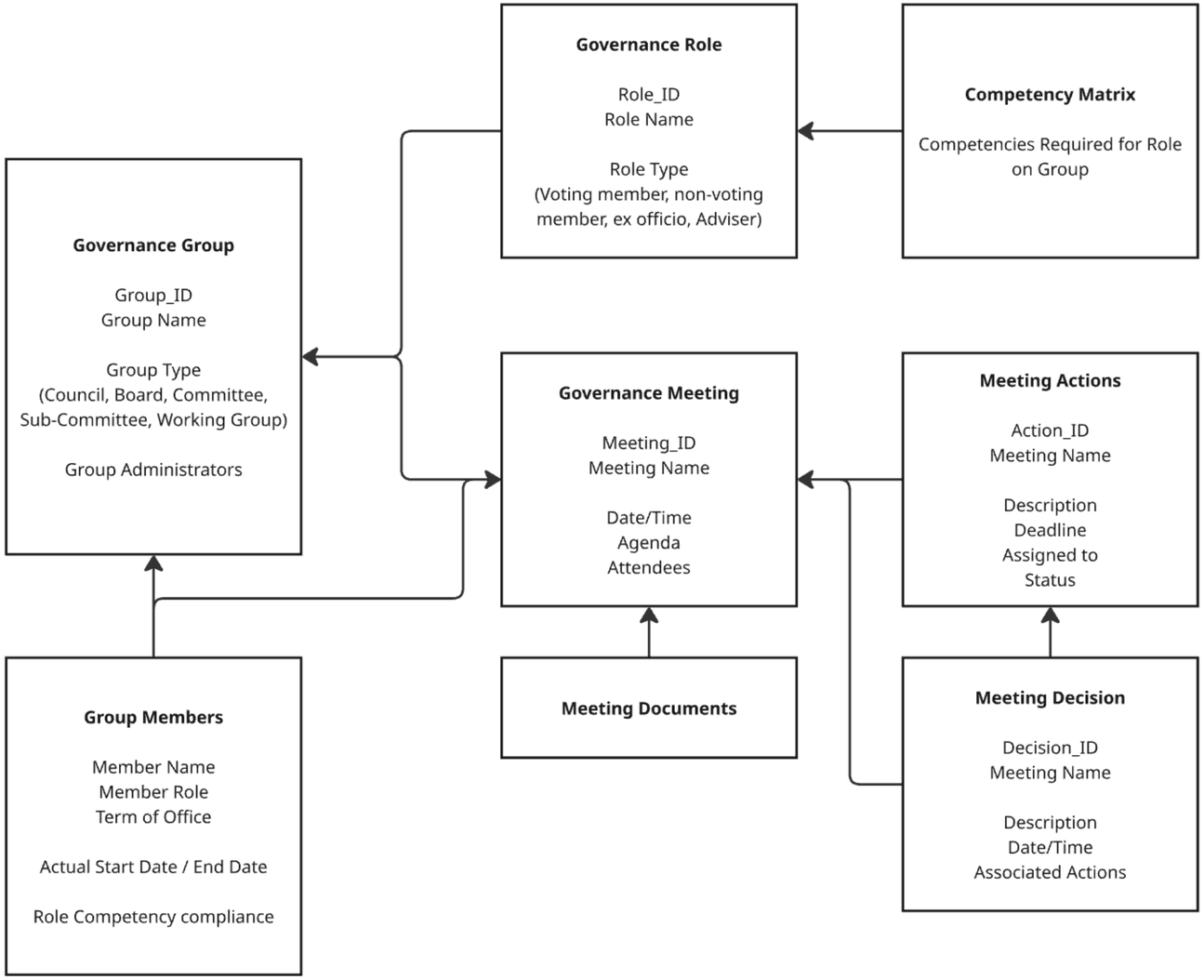
Event Management

Event Management

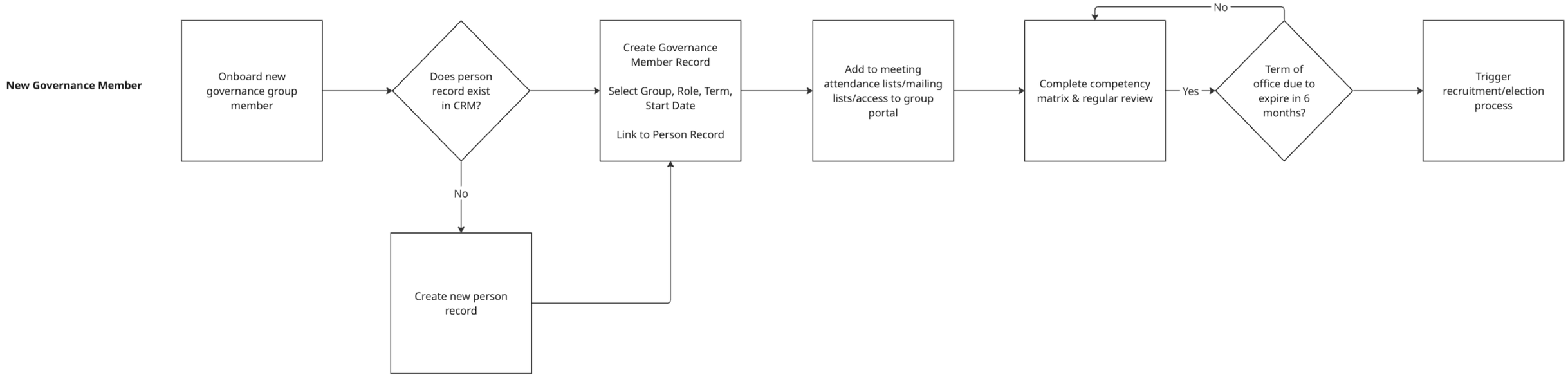


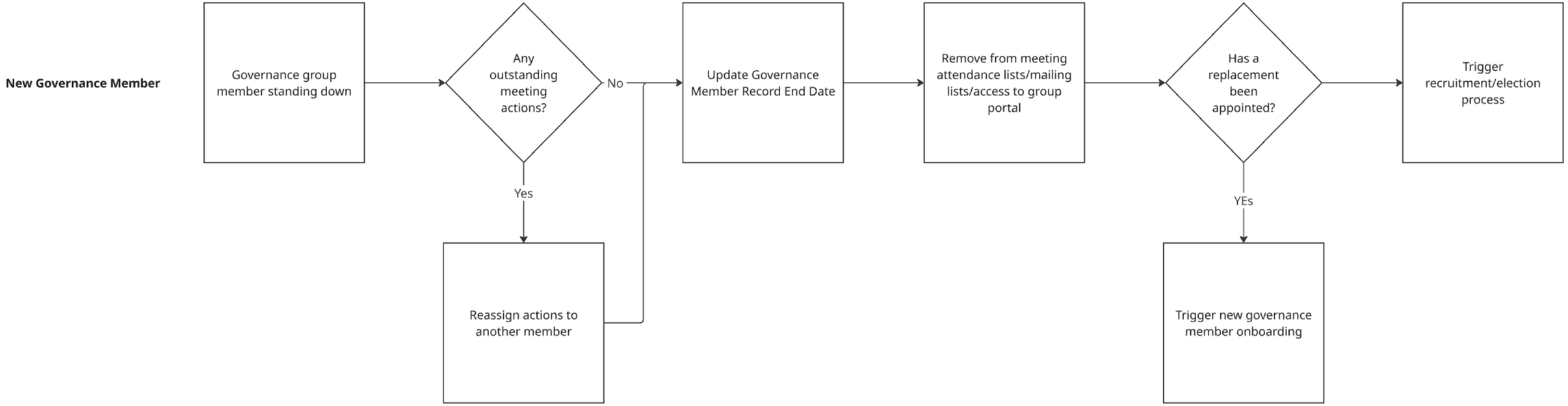
Governance Management

Governance Management – Core Entities

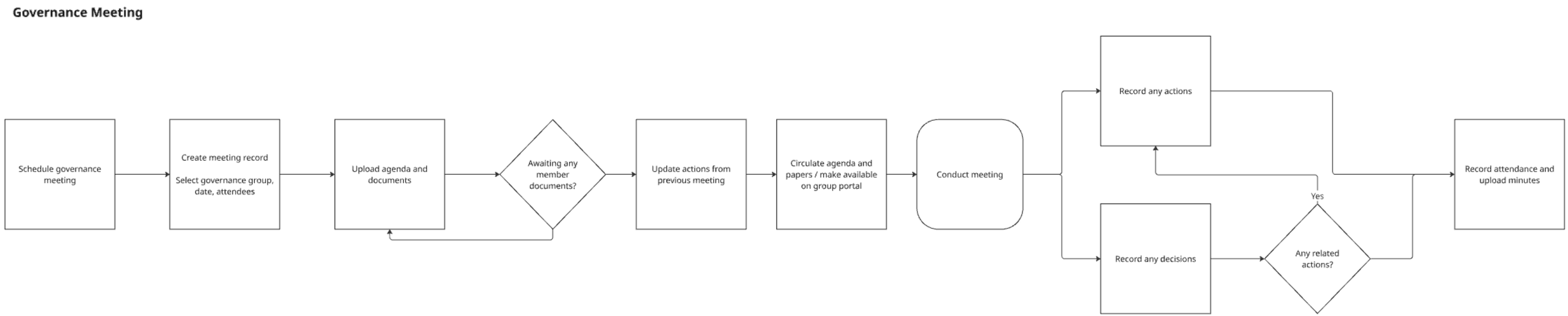


Governance Management (1)



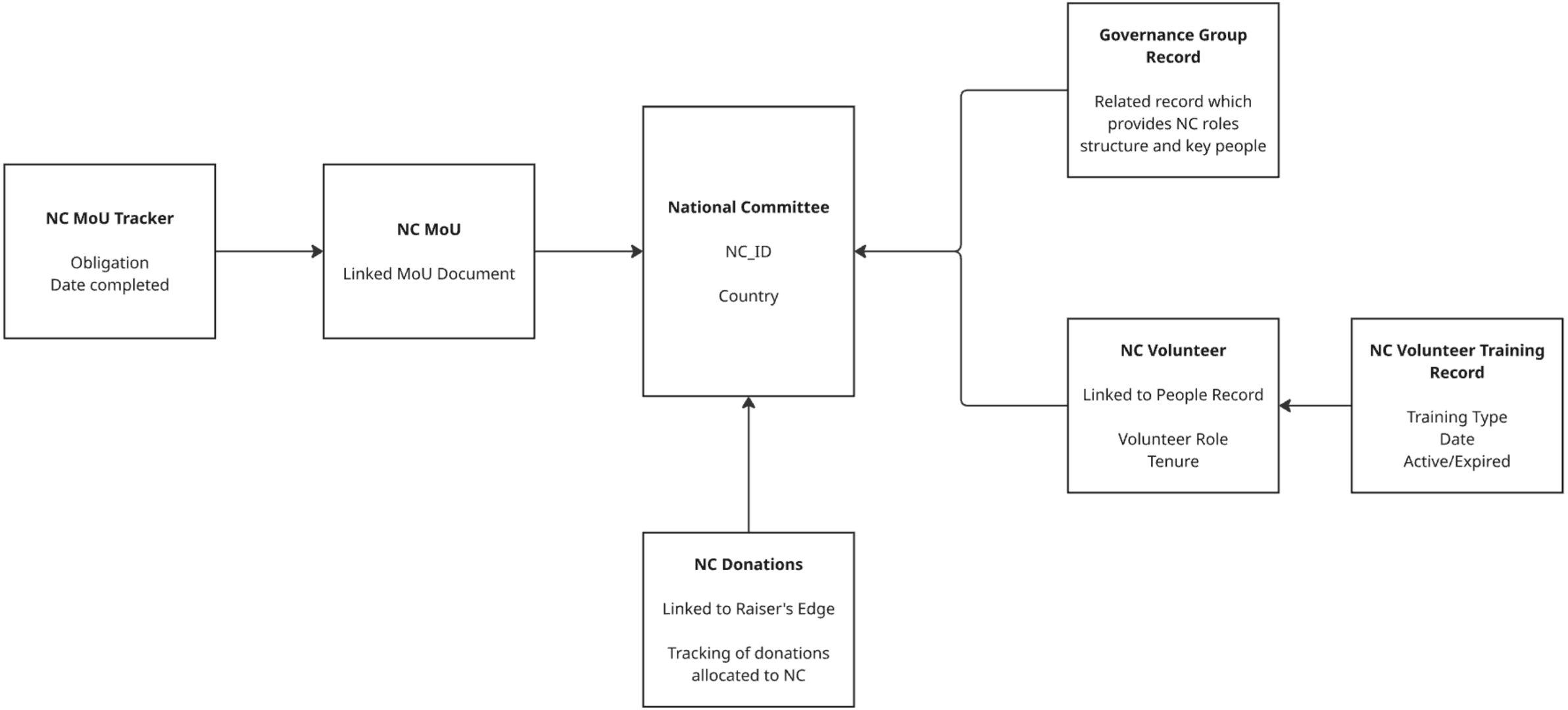


Governance Management (2)



National Committee Management

National Committee Management – Core Entities



Estimated User Numbers

Applications Platform

	Yr1	Yr2	Yr3	Yr4	Yr5
Super admin	3	3	3	3	3
Admin	156	158	160	162	164
Partial admin	400	419	446	463	490
Assessors	3,060	3,110	3,930	3,990	4,050
Applicant	31,500	55,500	58,000	60,500	63,000
Referee	53,000	103,500	108,000	112,500	117,000
Parent/Guardian	57,000	107,500	112,000	116,500	121,000
	145,119	270,190	282,539	294,118	305,707

CRM Platform

	Yr1	Yr2	Yr3	Yr4	Yr5
Super admin	3	3	3	3	3
Admin	5	5	5	5	5
Regular user	550	570	590	610	629
	558	578	598	618	637

User Definitions

Super Admin	Platform ownership level - full access
Admin	Administration at a NC or IO team level - managing application cycles, local user account management, etc
Partial Admin	Very limited administrative access - applicant support queries, managing workflows, etc

UWC